

BJAY MBURU MAKARA

Junior Software Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Junior Software Developer with hands-on experience building full-stack web applications using Angular, Laravel, React, Next.js, TypeScript and PostgreSQL. Experienced in developing REST APIs, implementing authentication, documenting software, and collaborating in agile teams during a professional software development attachment. Passionate about building scalable applications and continuously learning modern software engineering practices.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), PHP, Python, SQL

Frontend: Angular, DevExtreme (DataGrid, forms, CustomStore), RxJS, reactive forms, route guards, React, Next.js 15, Redux Toolkit, Tailwind CSS, Material-UI, HTML5, CSS3, Recharts

Backend: Laravel (Eloquent, Query Builder, migrations, middleware), Laravel Sanctum, Django REST Framework, Node.js, Express.js, REST API design, JWT authentication, CORS

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Firebase Firestore — normalisation, schema design, joins, indexing, transactions

Documentation & QA: OpenAPI/Swagger annotations, Material for MkDocs, user acceptance testing, structured findings logs, requirements specification

Tools & practice: Git and GitHub (shared-repository workflow, pull requests, code review), Composer, npm, Angular CLI, HeidiSQL, Postman, Firebase, Vercel

Other: Software localisation (English, French, Swahili), technical writing

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Software Developer | Nextrans Solutions Limited, Nairobi

May 2026 – August 2026

Angular · DevExtreme · Laravel · Laravel Sanctum · PostgreSQL · TypeScript · PHP · Swagger · Git

- Built the backend of the Property and Rental Management System (PRMS) in Laravel and PostgreSQL — translated the data model into migrations, implemented CRUD controllers with shared helper methods, secured the API with Laravel Sanctum, and organised the codebase into responsibility-based modules.
- Developed the PRMS Angular and DevExtreme frontend: a shared layout backbone used across every page, Tenants and Properties components backed by DevExtreme grids and forms served through a CustomStore, an AuthService, page routing and canActivate route guards.
- Authored the PRMS User Requirements Specification (v1.3) after benchmarking eight established property management platforms, defining user roles and a permissions matrix, functional and non-functional requirements, use cases, success criteria, and an entity-relationship model spanning People & Access, Property & Tenancy, Billing & Payments and Operations.
- Delivered the Help Desk system backend on a normalised PostgreSQL schema with lookup tables, role-based access control, audit logging, SLA tracking and soft deletes.
- Ran user acceptance testing on ABREMA-uRIMS, a multi-module pharmaceutical regulatory platform — designed a repeatable four-lens QA methodology with a severity scale and structured findings log, and tested the GMP and Import/Export Permit workflows end to end.
- Documented ABREMA-uRIMS REST endpoints with Swagger annotations across several modules, and built a versioned digital manual site using Material for MkDocs.
- Localised the ABREMA-uRIMS interface into French and Swahili, maintaining a shared translation reference so terminology stayed consistent platform-wide.
- Built a full-stack Employee Management application (Angular, Laravel, PostgreSQL) with Sanctum token authentication, hashed credentials, protected routes, a statistics dashboard and full CRUD.
- Worked daily in a shared team repository — raising pull requests, reviewing colleagues' code, and resolving merge conflicts and CORS configuration issues.

PROJECTS

EquiTask — Workload Management System

Capstone project

Django REST Framework · React · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · scikit-learn · Redux Toolkit · JWT · Material-UI · Recharts

Live: <https://equitask-task-manager.vercel.app/> · Code: <https://github.com/Gabriel-Bjay/Equitask--task-manager>

- Designed and built the complete system independently — REST API, frontend, database schema and business logic.
- Built a scoring-based task recommendation engine that assigns work by matching required skills against each team member's current workload, removing manual assignment bias.
- Developed a live RAPID compliance dashboard in Recharts visualising how fairly tasks are distributed across a team.
- Secured the API with JWT authentication and consumed it from a React and TypeScript client using Redux Toolkit.
- Added a scikit-learn layer that retrains the recommendation weights from recorded outcomes.
- Deployed on Render, Vercel and Neon, with reminders, metrics and retraining scheduled on GitHub Actions.

VHS Video Store — Movie Discovery Platform

Deployed

Next.js 15 (App Router) · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Firebase Auth + Firestore · TMDB API · Vercel

Live: <https://vhs-video-store.vercel.app/>

- Built and deployed a full-stack movie discovery platform with real-time Firestore sync and Firebase email and Google authentication.
- Integrated the TMDB REST API for search and trending feeds, with persistent favourites and multi-list watchlists syncing live across devices.
- Shipped a fully responsive custom design system in Tailwind CSS v4 on the Next.js 15 App Router.

Property & Rental Management System (PRMS)

Deployed

Angular 22 · DevExtreme · TypeScript · Laravel 13 · PHP · PostgreSQL · Laravel Sanctum · Docker

Live: <https://rems-frontend-mu.vercel.app/>

- Built role-scoped access for landlords, agents and tenants: each role sees only its own properties and payments.
- Automated billing: per-period invoices, oldest-first payment allocation, overdue tracking and agent commissions.
- Shipped role-based dashboards, invoice and payment workflows, a maintenance board and a one-click live demo.

PR Concierge — GitHub App for Pull Request Reviews

Deployed

TypeScript · Node.js · Octokit (REST + GraphQL) · GitHub Apps · Vitest · Vercel

Live: <https://pr-concierge.vercel.app/> · Code: <https://github.com/Gabriel-Bjay/pr-concierge>

- Built a GitHub App that labels pull requests by size, keeps a self-updating checklist and nudges stale reviews.
- Kept it stateless to run as one serverless function on Vercel's free plan, with no duplicate comments or reminders.
- One-click setup via GitHub's App manifest flow, per-repository YAML config, and end-to-end webhook tests in Vitest.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science — Riara University, Nairobi

Sept 2023 – July 2027

Coursework completed; graduation scheduled July 2027

Full-Stack Software Development Certificate — Zindua School

Feb – Jul 2023

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education — Njiiri High School

2019 – 2022

CERTIFICATIONS

- Web Development Fundamentals — IBM SkillsBuild (March 2026)
- Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals with Capstone Project — IBM SkillsBuild (May 2025)
- Python Essentials — Cisco Networking Academy (September 2024)

ADDITIONAL

- Hackathon participant — Africa's Talking (2023)
- Member, RU I-Tech Society — Riara University (2025)